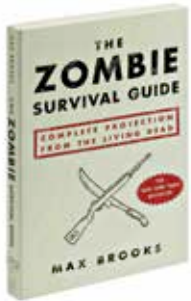


The Zombie Survival Guide

Everyone and their uncle remembers the godawful train wreck of an adaptation that was the Brad Pitt blockbuster World War Z. Unlike the Hollywood adaptation, Max Brook's original book wasn't just a mindless action shtick featuring zombies. It



was a masterpiece that used a zombie apocalypse as a crucible for examining the geopolitical and human ramifications of the apocalypse.

However, what started it all was Brook's seminal manual on zombie mythos – The Zombie Survival Guide. The book has been written in an uncannily serious manner, and bears a disconcertingly elaborate discourse ranging from the basics of zombie physiology to the careful selection of weapons and fortifications against the undead.

It's easy to pick it up in jest, but it doesn't take long for its meticulously detailed approach to make one doubt if this is indeed a work of fiction. Max Brook's defines suspension of disbelief with a keen eye for detail.

MOVIE

Ex Machina

What makes us human?

AI is an all-time favourite trope not just for science fiction, but even for Hollywood. The prospect of a machine becoming self-aware and sentient has always fascinated mankind. Ex Machina explores the same theme but does it with a lot of finesse. Tense, deep, philosophical and full of thought-provoking dialogue, Ex Machina sucks you in from the word go.

A young intrepid coder at Google, sorry BlueBook, wins a chance to spend a week with the company's eccentric founder at his remote sprawling estate in the middle of nowhere. This little win of course isn't as innocuous as it seems. Caleb, the talented young coder, has been brought in under this pretext of a competition by Nathan for the specific purpose of testing an AI prototype he's been working on. Caleb is to give his own assessment of whether the AI can pass the Turing Test.

The AI as it turns out is not a black box, but a deliciously realistic android named Ava. The sessions between Ava and Caleb are clinically observed over by Nathan via the building's CCTV system. It starts getting dark when suspicious power outages start occurring



during these sessions and Ava reveals some startling things about her creator Nathan.

Without telling you too much we can tell you that eventually Caleb realises he isn't a mere administrator of an experiment. Questions about what it means to be alive and the extents to which a being will fight for survival are brought up by the film. What we like is the realism, especially the kind of things that are truly plausible when you have the world's search data at

your fingertips. The performances by all four primary characters – Nathan, Ava, Caleb and Kyoko (a sort of full service Asian house keeper) – are brilliant.

Some might find the dialogue-heavy style a bit cumbersome to follow, but the movie is worth the effort. The end leaves you with a lot of questions unanswered and will make you question your own reality. A must watch Sci-Fi thriller for sure.

- Siddharth Parwatay



Supergirl

The 6-minute long trailer for Supergirl clearly depicted what a chick flick for superheroes would look like. Just like her cousin, no one recognises Supergirl with her glasses on.



Minority Report

Some sci-fi movies are worthy enough to be remembered, Minority Report falling among them. But the first look of the new TV series might just have revealed too much, leaving us unimpressed.



Limitless

Yet another movie is being rebooted as a TV series – probably the easy way out nowadays. Limitless was great indeed, and all of us actually looked for NZT-48 on the Internet. Oh, and Bradley Cooper will continue his character.